Which passage seems more interesting?

- Passage A
- Passage B
- Both are interesting; hard to say which is better
- Neither is interesting; hard to say which is better

Which passage has a more coherent overall plot?

- Passage A
- Passage B
- Both are quite coherent; hard to say which is better
- Neither is very coherent; hard to say which is better

Which passage is better focused on the given sub-event?

- Passage A
- Passage B
- Both closely follow the sub-event; hard to say which is better
- Neither closely follows the sub-event; hard to say which is better

Passage A:

might be too critical of it, and she didn't want to get too close to anyone until she knew what their response would be.

Abby thought about Shannon's situation for a while and then told her that she sounded a bit insecure and like she was afraid of getting hurt. She told Shannon that she shouldn't worry so much about what other people thought of her work, especially if they were the ones who were supposed to read it. If people didn't like the novel, then she would be able to tell by reading their reactions and she could make changes accordingly. But there wasn't much point in hiding for too long.

While Abby said this, Shannon slowly came to understand what Abby was saying, which allowed her to appreciate the advice more clearly. Shannon agreed with her friend and said that Abby was probably right about her needing to stop worrying so much about it, but she also told Abby that before she showed the work to others, there were still some other things that she wanted to do with it first. She told Abby about some of the changes that she had made and about how much she had learned through the process.

Abby was surprised by all of this and asked Shannon if she wantedany help in making her next novel. Shannon admitted that there was something she would like to ask Abby about and they agreed to meet for lunch the next day before the reading.

At home, Luke Saunders didn't get very far in his discussion with his mother about his future plans because she suddenly said that she needed to go out, and then quickly rushed off in her car while Luke was still talking. Charles Chambers was now dead, but Luke had always been a little jealous of him because he thought he got to do everything that he wanted. He didn't know what his mother's plans for tonight were, but he was pretty sure that they didn't involve him.

At the café next day, Shannon told Abby about how a few months earlier, she had spotted an older man who reminded her of her father and that he had introduced himself as Sam Shaw. She explained how he had managed to get her a meeting with his daughter, Samantha Shaw – the agent – and also arranged for her to take part in a two-week writing program at the New School. Shannon said that she had enjoyed both experiences and learned a lot, but then she confessed that even though she now had some confidence in her ability as a writer,she didn't know if she wanted to do it anymore.

Abby listened attentively before she asked why. Shannon admitted that at the end of the summer, when Sam Shaw's assistant had told her that he thought she had a voice, Shannon had felt really good about herself and she almost wanted to go back to where it all started, but instead she had gotten into an argument with Sam's assistant and said that he would never have made the same mistake if he was a woman. Abby asked Shannon if her argument was true.

Shannon said that it wasn't an easy question to answer, because she was still trying to work out what it meant to be a woman in the literary world and she didn't always understand what being a feminist meant. She explained that Sam Shaw had spent more time with Abby than he did with her because he thought she was a better writer.

Passage B:

to do myself, so I'll talk to you later!"

Shannon walked home with no idea of what her next step would be. She knew that she couldn't give up on writing, but for now she wasn't sure how much longer she could push through the pain of failure. She was so tired of trying and failing.

Finally, she arrived on her front porch. She unlocked the door and went inside, kicking off her shoes. Abby was sitting on the couch with a steaming mug of coffee in her hands. Shannon could tell that her best friend had been crying.

Shannon closed the door behind her and walked over to join her on the couch. "Where's your ring?" Shannon asked, noting that Abby's engagement ring was missing from her finger.

"Oh, I took it off because I keep hitting the buttons on the touch screen with my fat fingers. Now, Shannon! Tell me what you want to do about your stupid book! I don't understand what you see in writing anyway! You spend all of your time locked up in your home, typing away, getting no exercise at all. And what do you get for this? Nothing!

Shannon had never seen Abby so irritated. It made her mad and she was glad that her fiancé was out of town for work again. She moved the coffee mug out of her way and scooted over so that she was closer to Shannon. "Okay, you can move closer. I'm not going to bite you or anything. But you need to decide what it is that you want to do. Do you want to become a big-time author or do you want to just quit?"

Shannon moved away from her best friend and stood up. "I don't want to talk about this anymore. I'm going to go to sleep, okay?" Shannon said as she moved away, heading towards her bedroom.

"Shannon, come here! You can't just keep doing this! You need to do something about your stupid book and you need to do it right now!"

She turned around and headed back towards the living room. "What do you want me to do about it ?"

Abby took a deep breath. "I want you to write another book! Have you thought of that?"

Shannon thought for a second, then said, "I can't tell you anything about that right now. I'm just going to write a second book and then I'll send it to the publisher and they'll decide if they like it or not."

Shannon sat down on the couch and started to get serious about her writing career again. She decided that she was going to write another book for her agent, and then a third and a fourth book, then publish them all, one after another. She had been through this process before. Getting published in four years would be hard work, but it was doable. Shannon had been writing books for seven years. If she could write all these books, she would have a great career.

We're a group of NLP/AI researchers working on story generation. Below are two (lengthy) passages from stories based on the same premise. Each passage is supposed to narrate one main sub-event in the story, though it may also include some additional content before/after.

We just need high-level judgments related to overall relevance/coherence. Therefore, please **quickly skim** both passages; no need to read carefully (most passages will be 1000-1500 words). You can expect to spend about **a minute or two** per passage.

Finally, answer the brief questions at the end. Ideally this should only take about 30 seconds to a minute.

Overall Premise (for the whole story):
After the loss of her father, Shannon is determined to follow in his footsteps and become a successful author. However, when her first book is met with poor reviews, Shannon starts to doubt her talent. With the encouragement of her best friend, Shannon decides to write a second book, but this time she is going to write about what she knows best: her life.

Sub-Event:
Shannon's best friend encourages her to write a second book, this time about her life.

Figure 4: Surge AI annotation example for main comparisons in Table 1. The stories are truncated here for brevity.

Story Comparison Multi-Step Project - PHASE 1

Please write your ~30–60 word story premise here.

Minimum word count: 30 Maximum word count: 70 Words: 0

Optional Comments

Figure 5: Surge AI annotation example for human interactive experiment, Phase 1.

Story Comparison Multi-Step Project - PHASE 2

A young woman wakes one day to find that she has turned into a cat. Her family not knowing who she is puts her out on the street. She struggles on her own on the streets until she meets a young man that had also been turned into a cat. They form an instant bond and try to figure out what caused them both to change.

Phase 2 (Part 1)

The plan generated from your story premise has been recopied below for your convenience. Please look over the story plan, and simply edit according to your preference. You can fix errors, change the plot, etc; make as many or as few changes as you'd like, though try not to change the overall lengths or number of outline items too much. Remember that the time limit for Part 1 is 5 minutes.

Setting: The story is set in a small town in the United States.

Characters:

1.

Full Name: Lily Hendricks

Character Portrait: Lily Hendricks is a 19-year-old woman who turns into a black cat.

2.

Full Name: Max Robards

Character Portrait: Max Robards is a 21-year-old man who turns into a orange tabby cat.

Outline:

1. Lily wakes up one day to find that she has turned into a cat and her family does not know who she is. Scene: the family's home. Characters: Lily Hendricks, Aaron Hendricks, Natalie Hendricks

2. Lily meets Max, another cat who has also been turned into a cat, and the two form an instant bond. Scene: an alleyway. Characters: Lily Hendricks, Max Robards

3. Lily and Max try to figure out what caused them to change and how to change back. Scene: a library. Characters: Lily Hendricks, Max Robards

4. Lily and Max's families slowly begin to accept their new form and the two live happily together. Scene: the family's home. Characters: Lily Hendricks, Max Robards, Aaron Hendricks, June Robards, Edward Robards

Minimum word count: 0

Phase 2 (Part 2)

First, **please copy and paste your finalized revisions from Phase 2 (Part 1) into the field below.**

Then, if you have any additional minor edits you would still like to make, please spend up to a maximum of 10 more minutes making your edits. However, in this part, **please don't change the total number of outline items**. Again, it's fine if you feel you're done and spend less than the maximum time (or even no time at all if you're already satisfied!).

Optional Comments

Figure 6: Surge AI annotation example for human interactive experiment, Phase 2. Plans are abridged. The output of Phase 2 Part 2 is the final plan for RE^3 (System A).

Story Comparison Multi-Step Project - PHASE 3

A young man discovers he can travel back in time. As more people come to him and ask him to go back in time and prevent unfortunate events from happening, he's unable to keep up with all the demands. He's kidnapped by an unknown group to commit crimes and has to find his way out and use his powers for good.

Setting: The story is set in a modern-day city.

Characters:

1.

Full Name: Malik Johnson

Character Portrait: Malik Johnson is a young black man with a shaved head and an athletic build.

2.

Full Name: Emily Saunders

Character Portrait: Emily Saunders is a young white woman with long blonde hair and blue eyes.

Phase 3

The expanded outline generated from your story premise has been recopied below for your convenience. Once again, you can fix errors, edit the plot, etc; make as many or as few changes as you'd like, though try not to change the overall lengths too much. It's fine if you'd like to change the preexisting parts of the plan, but please focus primarily on the newly added parts of the outline.

Remember that the time limit for Part 3 is 5 minutes.

Setting: The story is set in a modern-day city.

Characters:

1.

Full Name: Malik Johnson

Character Portrait: Malik Johnson is a young black man with a shaved head and an athletic build.

2.

Full Name: Emily Saunders

Character Portrait: Emily Saunders is a young white woman with long blonde hair and blue eyes.

Outline:

1. Malik Johnson discovers that he can travel back in time. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson

   a. Malik Johnson discovers that he can travel back in time. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson

   b. People start coming to him and asking him to change events in their lives. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Dale Wilkins, Nathan Harris, Malik Johnson

2. Emily Saunders asks Malik to go back in time and prevent her sister's death. Scene: a modern-day city, 5 years prior to the main timeline. Characters: Emily Saunders, Malik Johnson, Katrina Saunders, Amara Singh

   a. Emily Saunders asks Malik to travel back in time and prevent her sister's death. Scene: a modern-day city, 5 years prior to the main timeline. Characters: Malik Johnson, Emily Saunders, Katrina Saunders

   b. Malik travels back in time but is unable to save her sister. Scene: a modern-day city, 5 years prior to the main timeline. Characters: Malik Johnson

3. Nathan Harris kidnaps Malik and forces him to commit crimes for him. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Nathan Harris, Malik Johnson

   a. Nathan Harris kidnaps Malik. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson, Nathan Harris

   b. Nathan Harris forces Malik to commit crimes for him. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson, Nathan Harris

4. Dale Wilkins helps Malik escape and uses his powers for good. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Dale Wilkins, Malik Johnson

   a. Dale Wilkins helps Malik escape. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson, Dale Wilkins

   b. Malik uses his powers for good. Scene: a modern-day city. Characters: Malik Johnson

Minimum word count: 0

Optional Comments

Figure 7: Surge AI annotation example for human interactive experiment, Phase 3. Plans are abridged.